Use ChatGPT to Map Out What Could Help Pay for Dad's Care Later

Four prompts to list the resources Dad has, find the policies and benefits nobody has looked at lately, separate what you've heard from what you've confirmed, and put your questions for a professional on one page.

Where you are

Dad is managing on his own and nobody is paying for care. You've started to wonder how the family would pay if that changed, and you realize you know only pieces: some savings, a policy or two, and things you've heard about Medicaid.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names and account numbers removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not know your state's Medicaid rules, judge eligibility, or give legal, financial, or insurance advice. Bring those questions to your Medicaid planner or the appropriate licensed professional.

What you'll have at the end

You have a dated page showing what could help pay for care, what nobody has checked, and the questions to bring to a professional while there is no decision to make.

A one-page funding picture: Resources we know about, Policies and benefits to check, What we've heard but not confirmed, and Questions for a professional.

Before you start

- A rough list of Dad's income, savings, and property. Names of things are enough; you don't need balances.
- Any insurance policies or benefits you know of, even if you've never read them.
- Things you've heard about paying for care or Medicaid that you're not sure are true. Two of the three is plenty.

PROMPT 1

List what could help pay for care

WHY THIS MATTERS

Most families know pieces: a pension here, a policy there, the house. Nobody has put them on one page. You don't need balances to start. You need to know what exists and who knows the details.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

A rough list of Dad's income, savings, property, and policies.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> I'm planning ahead for my father. No one is paying for long-term care yet. Here is what I know about the resources he has:

> [PASTE YOUR NOTES, WITH NAMES AND ACCOUNT NUMBERS REMOVED]
>
> Turn this into a dated list with these headings: INCOME, SAVINGS AND INVESTMENTS, RETIREMENT ACCOUNTS, INSURANCE POLICIES, BENEFITS, PROPERTY. Under each heading, put only what I described. Where I said nothing, write “not noted” so I can see the blank. Do not estimate values, do not estimate what care would cost, and do not say how Medicaid would treat anything.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A first list with blanks you can see, not a financial analysis.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Put today's date at the top and note who in the family could fill in each blank.

PROMPT 2

Find the policies and benefits nobody has looked at lately

WHY THIS MATTERS

A long-term care policy bought years ago, a life insurance policy, an annuity, a veteran's benefit: families often know these exist without knowing what they say. What each one would do when care is needed is a question for the company or a licensed professional.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Whatever you know about each policy or benefit: the kind, the company, roughly when it started.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is what I know about my father's insurance policies, annuities, and benefits:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> For each one, make a short entry: WHAT IT IS, WHAT PAPERWORK WE HAVE, WHEN IT WAS LAST REVIEWED (or “unknown”), and QUESTIONS TO ASK THE COMPANY OR A LICENSED PROFESSIONAL. Do not tell me what any policy covers or is worth, and do not suggest buying, changing, or cancelling anything. Then ask me five questions about kinds of coverage or benefits I haven't mentioned, such as long-term care insurance, life insurance, health coverage, or veterans benefits.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

The entries marked “unknown.” Those are the calls to make.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Find the paperwork for one “unknown” entry and write down who to call about it.

PROMPT 3

Separate what you've heard from what you've confirmed

WHY THIS MATTERS

Planning ahead comes with a lot of confident advice about giving money away, spending it first, or a product that takes care of everything. Some of it may apply to your family and some may not. Writing each one down as a question keeps something you heard from turning into a decision.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The things you've heard or read about paying for care and Medicaid, and where each came from.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here are things our family has heard or read about paying for long-term care and about Medicaid, with where each came from:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Make a three-column table: WHAT WE HEARD, WHERE IT CAME FROM, and THE QUESTION TO ASK A PROFESSIONAL. Do not tell me whether any of it is true, and do not state any Medicaid rule, limit, or time period; rules vary by state and can change. If an item would lead us to give away, move, or retitle anything, or to buy a financial product, mark it ASK FIRST.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Ideas you were treating as settled that are really open questions.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Move the ASK FIRST lines to the top of your question list.

PROMPT 4

Put the funding picture and your questions on one page

WHY THIS MATTERS

Planning ahead doesn't mean deciding everything now. It means knowing what you have, what you haven't checked, who to ask, and what would make you look again.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The results of the first three prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is what I've put together about how my father's care might be paid for:
>
> [PASTE THE RESULTS OF PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Write one page with four headings: RESOURCES WE KNOW ABOUT, POLICIES AND BENEFITS TO CHECK, WHAT WE'VE HEARD BUT NOT CONFIRMED, and QUESTIONS FOR A PROFESSIONAL. Mark each question with who should answer it: family, a Medicaid planner, an elder law attorney, a licensed insurance or financial professional, or not sure. At the bottom, add a line titled REVIEW THIS PAGE WHEN, listing a major change in health, finances, marital status, or care needs. Do not project costs, do not answer the questions, and do not recommend any strategy or product.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A short, dated page with each question sorted by who can answer it.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Share the page with one other family member and agree when to look at it again.

Take the page one step further

You've put the funding picture and your questions on one page. The next step is the planning interview, which produces a free planning report you can bring to your Medicaid planner.

Get Your Free Planning Report ›